046. Al-Ahqaaf - The Sand Dunes

35 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

REFLECTION ON THE SIGNS OF ALLAH AND THE PUNISHMENT THAT AWAITS THOSE WHO DENY THEM
A FOCUS ON PARENTS
REJECTION OF GUIDANCE BY THE PEOPLE OF AHQAAF VS ACCEPTANCE BY THE JINN

DID YOU KNOW?

IT TAKES ITS NAME FROM THE MENTION OF THE SAND DUNES IN VERSE 21 WHERE PROPHET HUD WAS SENT TO THE TRIBE OF 'AAD. THE SAND DUNES ARE MADE BY THE WIND.
IT IS THE SEVENTH CHAPTER OF A GROUP CALLED THE HAWAMEEM (40-46) REVEALED IN SEQUENCE AND ALL BEGINNING WITH 'HAA MEEM'
"I HAVE BEEN GIVEN HAWAAMEEN AS A GIFT" PROPHET (PBUH)

SELECTED AYAAT

46:15	A mother's difficulty and weaning of a child is 30 months
46:17	No disrespect to parents, not even 'uf'
46:21	Ahqaaf (sand dunes)
46:29	Jinn listening to Qur'an

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH A CHALLENGE TO THOSE WHO REJECT DIVINE GUIDANCE CALLING THEM TO ACOUNT FOR THEIR REJECTION AND REQUESTING PROOF TO PROVE THEIR CASE. IT THEN TRANSITIONS INTO A CONVERSATION ON THE RIGHTS OF PARENTS AND THE IMPORTANCE OF RESPECT AND PRAYING FOR THEM. THOSE WHO RESPECT PARENTS ARE GRANTED THE BEST OF WHAT THEY DO AND THEIR EVIL DEEDS ARE OVERLOOKED WHILST THOSE WHO DISRESPECT PARENTS ARE DEEMED AS FAILURES BY DIVINITY. A DISCUSSION ON THE JUST RECOMPENSE OF DEEDS ON ONE'S INDIVIDUAL MERITS TRANSTIONS INTO THE STORY OF PROPHET HUD AND THE MANNER IN WHICH HIS PEOPLE WERE PUNISHED FOR REJECTING HIM. THIS IS FOLLOWED BY THE RECOUNTING OF THE STORY OF THE JINN WHO HEARD THE QUR'AN AND CALLED THEIR PEOPLE TO FOLLOW THE PROPHET.
THE CHAPTER ENDS WITH A COUNSEL TO THE PROPHET TO HAVE PATIENCE TO ENDURE THE REJECTION OF THE MAKKANS LIKE THE PROPHETS BEFORE HIM.